

# Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

## Suspect arrested in killing of Kirk

Family helped turn in man who became 'more political' lately

By Eric Tucker, Alanna Durkin Richer, Jesse Bedayn and Hannah Schoenbaum  
Associated Press

OREM, Utah — A 22-year-old Utah man who was arrested and booked on murder charges in the assassination of Charlie Kirk held disdain for the conservative activist and indicated to a family member that he was responsible for the shooting, authorities said Friday.

The arrest marked a major break in a case that shocked the country and raised fresh alarms about political violence in a deeply polarized United States.

Tyler Robinson, 22, had become "more political" in the run-up to the shooting and mentioned during a dinner with family that Kirk would be visiting Utah, Gov. Spencer Cox said at a news conference. The governor cited as evidence engravings on bullet casings found in the rifle that authorities believe was used in the attack, as well as chat app messages attributed to the suspect that a roommate shared with law enforcement.

The governor credited Robinson's family with helping turn him over to authorities.

"Ladies and gentlemen, we got him," Cox said soon after the arrest was first heralded by President Donald Trump on the Fox News show "Fox & Friends."

Robinson is believed to have acted alone, and the investigation is ongoing, Cox said. He was arrested on suspicion of capital murder, and weapons and obstruction offenses. He is expected to be formally charged Tuesday ahead of an initial court appearance.

Robinson's arrest late Thursday capped a frenetic day-and-a-half search that just hours

Turn to Kirk, Page 6

## 'Civil war' rhetoric

Minutes after the shooting of right-wing influencer Charlie Kirk in Utah on Wednesday, calls for civil war began appearing online. The talk of civil war came largely from Republican lawmakers, right-wing media personalities and conservative podcasters. Some questioned whether America was already engaged in a civil war over its values, while others called for violence after Kirk's death.

Nation & World

# AGENT KILLS MAN DURING ICE 'BLITZ'

In Franklin Park: Shooting amid traffic stop brings calls for more transparency

In Broadview: Emotions high as protesters confront feds at processing facility



FBI employees watch as a vehicle is towed from the scene where an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer killed a man after the agency says he tried to flee a traffic stop in the car and struck an officer with his vehicle on Friday in Franklin Park. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As agents appear in riot gear, candidates, activists decry tactics

By Caroline Kubzansky, Dan Petrella, Rick Pearson, Olivia Olander and Rebecca Johnson  
Chicago Tribune

Despite President Donald Trump announcing he was sending National Guard troops to Memphis, and not Chicago, emotions in the region remained at a near-fever pitch Friday as protesters — including two candidates for Congress — confronted federal agents outside an immigration processing center in a near-west suburb.

In the city, meanwhile, Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker's Gold Coast home became the focal point of a recent video from a right-wing internet provocateur as he used the fatal shooting of conservative activist Charlie Kirk to call for his social media followers to "take action," sparking safety concerns among the



A protester yells at federal agents as the officers attempt to clear a path for their vehicles to enter and exit the ICE facility in Broadview on Friday. DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

governor's supporters.

Protests outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview have been occurring nearly daily, but Friday's actions became more tense as roughly a dozen agents in full riot gear with rifles appeared several

times as about three dozen protesters gathered around the two-story brick building on Beach Street.

At one point, the agents approached about 30 protesters in a line and pushing and shoving

Turn to Protests, Page 4

Feds claim officer acted appropriately amid alleged threat

By Jason Meisner and Rebecca Johnson  
Chicago Tribune

The Trump administration's nascent immigration-enforcement push in the Chicago area took a violent turn Friday when agents fatally shot a man in Franklin Park after he allegedly tried to flee a traffic stop and struck the officer with his vehicle, leaving him with serious injuries.

The incident in the typically quiet, working-class northwest suburb, which has a population that is more than half Hispanic, immediately brought calls for transparency from Illinois political leaders and condemnation from activists who decried the "aggressive" tactics of immigration agents.

Turn to Shooting, Page 4

## ELECTION 2026 ILLINOIS GOVERNOR

# Launching run, GOP's Dabrowski leaves more questions than answers

By Jeremy Gorner and Rick Pearson  
Chicago Tribune

In an inauspicious launch to his campaign for governor, conservative activist Ted Dabrowski left more questions than answers Friday as he acknowledged the skepticism that exists about the GOP's future in deep-blue Illinois.

After delivering a campaign speech of just under nine minutes, Dabrowski immediately turned

from a makeshift lectern and walked up the steps into his Wilmette home — refusing to take any questions from reporters. An aide said the nascent candidate had to attend to "previously scheduled radio" interviews.

That left unanswered several questions about the first-time candidate's sometimes-controversial background and associations in his tenure as the former president of the Wirepoints conservative action organization and his previ-

ous work as senior vice president at the conservative-aligned Illinois Policy Institute.

And while Dabrowski introduced his newly minted running mate, emergency room Dr. Carrie Mendoza, neither he nor his campaign team made her available to answer questions about her background opposing transgender-affirming care procedures, in which she likened the "orthodoxy" behind them to sterilizations and mutations conducted in

Nazi Germany.

Dabrowski did allow his mother, Blanca, to speak, and she said her son would "bring Illinois back into the glory of the '60s" but did not elaborate.

"I am someone who has never been content about being right without making sure it's done right," Dabrowski said in explaining why he was seeking the nomination.

"While I'm not from the political system, I know the system. I

know the players. I know how the sausage is made and why it tastes so bad," he said. "And I know that if we don't revitalize the Republican Party with strong executive leadership, we cannot resuscitate the state of Illinois."

Dabrowski is seeking to become the GOP nominee and will be running in the Republican primary in March. He is not a familiar name to most people outside

Turn to Governor, Page 2

## State to set vaccine guidelines

Illinois will move toward enacting its own guidelines on vaccines, following the federal government's decision to limit COVID-19 vaccine use. **Chicagoland, Page 2**

## Fallout in Hyundai raid mounts

President Donald Trump aims to undo damage after an immigration raid at a Georgia automaker plant runs up against his goals for foreign investment. **Business**

## Cubs inch closer to clinching

The magic number for the Cubs to clinch a postseason spot is down to seven after a 6-4 win over the Rays on Friday, with a home series likely. **Chicago Sports**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 78 Low 65

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere  
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